19.8 Falls in Older Adults at Home*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I fell twice this year in the bathroom." **Objective** • Aged 78 • Walks slowly, holding furniture • Poor lighting at home	**ACTUAL** Impaired walking ability related to muscle weakness and impaired balance as evidenced by a slow, unsteady gait.	• Walks safely with an aid within 2 weeks.	• Assess her gait, balance and home. • Provide a walking aid and teach its use. • Encourage balance and strength exercises. • Review with the physician any medicines that may cause dizziness.	• Goal reached when she walks safely.
Subjective • "I did not know my slippers were dangerous." **Objective** • Loose slippers • Rugs on the floor	**ACTUAL** Inadequate health knowledge related to home fall hazards as evidenced by unsafe footwear and rugs.	• Describes the changes that will make her home safer.	• Explain why well-fitting footwear matters. • Advise taking up rugs and fitting grab bars and night lights. • Check the home again at the next visit.	• Met when she describes the changes.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Has fallen before • Older adult	**RISK** Risk for adult falls as evidenced by risk factors: history of falls, advanced age and home hazards.	• No further falls.	• Teach her how to get up after a fall and call for help. • Arrange follow-up visits. • Suggest a personal alarm.	• Achieved if she does not fall again.

* **References for this care plan:** [35], [51], [53], [126]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.